



about 55 to 60% is protection insurance, which is health and term. On the savings side, it is about 25% and about 15% is from motor insurance.

While motor insurance is growing, the rest of the business—health and life—are growing at a much faster pace. And that's partly because it's a deeper focus for us. If I look at health and life, it has been growing faster than the average almost throughout the year. There is no doubt about that. If you put health and life

together, it would now be more than 80% of our premium.

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Irdai has approved Bima Sugam—an online marketplace for insurance. How will it impact your business?

I think it would expand the market and there is a lot of back-end work that needs to happen. There are databases that would be very useful in the insurance industry. But I don't know if the databases would become available to either

distributors or insurance companies, both private and public, because those are governmental databases. However, a government company could have access to them and through that they could provide the benefit to the insurance industry in some way. I think that back-end integration will really benefit the entire insurance industry.

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But how will it affect Policybazaar's business?
It will benefit us also.

When customers come to me, I don't have to ask them 20 questions because all of this data will be available through just one link. It will make the transaction easier. And that obviously will expand our ability to have more sales.

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Health insurance premiums have risen over the last couple of years. Has the high premium led to an increase in portability?

At our end, there has been no increase. In fact, it is quite controlled because we don't proactively reach out to customers suggesting portability. We, of course, support them only if a customer explicitly says they do want to port.

As far as the industry is concerned, yes, portability is increasing every couple of years. So whenever you see it—in every two years—the number is higher.

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What are some challenges the industry is facing?

As I said, we are doing better than expected right now. On the growth side, there is nothing to complain about. From a challenge perspective, I think trust is the biggest challenge for the entire industry and that comes from settling claims easily.

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Do you have any plans of listing Paisabazaar?

No, not as of now. BT

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